fueled idea, totally unrelated to the universal wave function. Jotting notes on hotel stationery while downing several pints of beer, Everett developed a new optimization algorithm for allocating military resources. It was easy to apply and fast to run on the bulky and slow computers of the time. When he returned home, Everett secured a patent for his algorithm, and it ultimately made him and his circle of military-industrial colleagues rich. Everett finally had what he wanted: a never-ending supply of booze, food, and cigarettes. Life was good.

Meanwhile, Everett's quantum ideas languished. Wheeler's prediction did not come to pass: there was even less discussion of Everett's theory than there had been of Bohm's. One of the few times Everett's theory was remembered was at a conference on the foundations of quantum physics in 1962 at Xavier University, organized by Boris Podolsky, the "P" in EPR. This was one of the first conferences to discuss the philosophical underpinnings of quantum theory since the Einstein-Bohr debates thirty years earlier. But unlike those conferences, this conference was decidedly low profile—as Podolsky mentioned in his opening remarks, "We want the participants to feel free to express themselves spontaneously… without things getting out in the newspapers." After all, the foundations of quantum physics were settled, and investigating them was at best a waste of time—and, at worst, a sign you were a Communist. Yet there were also a surprising number of big names there: the foundations of quantum physics were still troubling to some. In addition to Podolsky, Rosen (the "R" of EPR) was there, as was Paul Dirac, the father of relativistic quantum field theory; so was Wigner. And, while Bohm was still in exile and couldn't attend, his former student Aharonov was there. The conference attendees spent three days discussing the measurement problem, the inconsistencies of the Copenhagen interpretation, and alternatives like Bohm's pilot-wave theory. At one point on the first day, discussing the trickiness of wave function collapse, someone pointed out that Everett had a theory in which there was no collapse at all. The organizers decided to extend a belated invitation to Everett, and he flew up to Xavier from DC for the second day of the conference. The assembled luminaries interrogated Everett. "It looks like we would have a non-denumerable infinity of worlds," commented Podolsky. "Yes," Everett replied. At this point, one of the attendees, Wendell Furry, voiced his disbelief at the number of worlds involved. "I can